James "Jym" T. Paschall

Senior Site Reliability Engineer
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I learned engineering by volunteering for the problem nobody else knew how to solve, then staying with it until it worked. I dig until the root cause turns up, take painful manual processes apart and rebuild them as automation, and make sure the engineer who was stuck isn't stuck anymore. At Cisco's Duo Security, that meant owning the AWS guardrails across Commercial, Dev, and Federal environments and cutting unassigned security tickets from about 400 a week to under 5.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Site Reliability:** SLA/SLO/SLI, RTO/RPO, on-call (Federal, commercial production, and global data-center operations), incident response, disaster recovery, multi-environment operations
- **Cloud & Infrastructure:** AWS (EC2, S3, RDS, EKS, IAM, Lambda, Organizations), Terraform, Terraform Cloud, CloudFormation, Ansible, Linux
- **Security & Compliance:** Guardrails, SCPs, IAM, SOC 2, ISO 27001, FedRAMP Moderate (scoping), CIS Benchmarks, vulnerability management, audit readiness
- **Software & Automation:** Python, Java, Bash, HCL, YAML, Lambda microservices, CI/CD, Git, GitHub, GitLab, Bitbucket
- **Observability:** Datadog, CloudWatch, Splunk, Kibana, Nagios, OpsView, Pingdom, Opsgenie
- **AI-Augmented Engineering:** Claude Code, LLM workflows, AI-assisted code review and automation
- **Working Knowledge:** Docker, Kubernetes, Teleport, SSO/Active Directory integration

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Cisco | Senior Site Reliability Engineer **Jul 2025 - Jul 2026**
Duo Security's Risk & Compliance team *Remote*

- Cut unassigned security tickets from about 400 a week to under 5 by building an AWS Lambda notification microservice, saving an estimated 20 hours of manual triage per engineer each week (more than 1,000 engineering hours a year).
- Owned the Guardrails program: the SCPs and CloudFormation templates that enforce security and compliance baselines across Duo's AWS estate. Refactored 10 of 22 core templates and locked down public access on AMIs, EKS, and RDS.
- Held Federal Moderate on-call shifts for services maintaining a 99.99% availability SLA, responding to live alerts and keeping recovery within RTO/RPO policy.
- Contributed to Commercial CAP audit preparation and vulnerability management reporting aligned with SOC 2 and ISO 27001, and scoped the upcoming FedRAMP Moderate audit cycle.
- Held production admin across Dev, Commercial, FedRAMP Moderate, and AWS GovCloud accounts, plus the organization's payer and Guardrails accounts, including employee access provisioning, with attention to least privilege and a clean audit trail.
- Removed legacy tooling across 143 files in 4 environments (Terraform Cloud, Commercial, Dev, Federal), ending a recurring source of manual maintenance.
- Served as onboarding shepherd and Terraform SME, helped colleagues move to a new Teleport-based access model, and unblocked partner teams on SCPs and compliance tagging.
- Brought Claude Code and LLM workflows into daily engineering for script maintenance, code review, and infrastructure automation.

Next Tuesday, LLC | Independent DevOps Consultant **Jun 2025 - Jul 2025**
Consulting between staff roles *Remote*

- Consulted on a client's existing Terraform codebase: reviewed it against best practices, helped align module scope and structure, and flagged security compliance issues such as open CIDR ranges and hardcoded secrets.

Karma Automotive | Senior DevOps Engineer **Feb 2024 - Jul 2024**
Joined when Karma acquired the platform I supported at Airbiquity *Irvine, CA (Remote)*

- Re-architected AWS Terraform into a modular, multi-repository codebase, decoupling 75,000+ lines of code into smaller modules that limit the blast radius of each change.
- Sped up automated deployments by 60% by cleaning up infrastructure code carried over from Airbiquity.
- Saved $3,600 a month per AWS account by removing unused resources and hardening security.
- As one of three DevOps engineers, helped introduce CI/CD to product teams that had none, improving release reliability by 95%.
- Built a Docker and Kubernetes roadmap to make workloads more resilient and deployments faster.

Airbiquity | Senior DevOps Engineer **Mar 2020 - Feb 2024**
Connected-vehicle software *Seattle, WA*

- Centralized 23 standalone AWS accounts, previously tracked only in Confluence, under AWS Organizations and consolidated metrics and alerting in Datadog.
- Remediated AWS resources against the CIS AWS Foundations Benchmark and helped build automated tests to verify coverage, earning a 95%+ score on the formal CIS assessment.
- Cut manual deployments run from local machines from 5 days to 4 hours by restructuring Terraform modules, removing hardcoded values, and adding helper scripts, freeing DevOps and product teams for feature work.
- Halved deploy time by fixing out-of-order Terraform module dependencies and, with another DevOps engineer, moving AMI builds into an automated, pre-hardened image pipeline.
- Maintained a 99.99% SLA across global and on-prem Linux servers, including on-call for commercial production and global data-center operations.
- Modernized authentication by integrating SSO with Active Directory, cutting account management overhead by 80%.
- Led global operations and troubleshot network issues across AWS and on-prem data centers.
- Mentored engineers in Terraform best practices and DevOps methods.

Earlier: Freelance web developer and business tech support at Speakeasy.

CLEARANCES & CERTIFICATIONS

- CitVal (Cisco Citizen Validation): authorized for U.S. Federal environment access
- Production Admin: Duo Security's Dev, Commercial, FedRAMP Moderate, and AWS GovCloud accounts
- Federal OnCall Certified: Cisco's Duo Security

EDUCATION

- Full Stack Development Technical Certification, Coding Dojo, Bellevue, WA
- Technical Certification, University of Washington, Seattle, WA

Before tech: *eight years as a professional circus performer (acrobat, aerialist, and clown).*